

Good afternoon, my name is Carmina Taylor, I am an activist for the people of Pennsylvania. I am the Founder of the statewide advocacy group, "We Can't Wait PA Statewide Coalition and the Founder of the Movement for Black and Brown Lives in Montgomery County. However, what I am most proud of, is my leadership role in edifying the minds of my Montgomery County Cultural Proficiency and Equity Student Ambassadors. I am here today for them, to stand up and speak up for their future!

The next redistricting process of our federal and state legislative map has to be an exercise of real democracy in action. We need to demonstrate to our young people that for once we will set aside the wrangling of politics and we demonstrate that their voices ARE heard! That all of our voices are heard!

Right now our young people have ascertained that restricting is about race and suppressing the Black vote. They are aware of the Compromise of 1787 where Black slaves were deemed as $\frac{3}{5}$ of a white person as a form of representation in the House of Representatives. They understand that historical context and how that has become a foundation for skeptical thinking of whether American democracy really exists.

Our young people in Pennsylvania are looking for a cascade of justice around restricting that involves real transparency of the redistricting process, less conflict between political parties, real accountability in the final decision making process and fairness for both sides.

Young people in Pennsylvania want this redistricting process to be the opportunity for our General Assembly to set a real precedent for the rest of the United States.

I have taught our young people to be mindful of institutional power and how it plays out. I have asked them to examine the legal system with a justice equity lens, I have asked them to examine our social structures with a cultural equity lens and I have asked them to examine through research our political structures with a power equity lens. What lens will you put on during this next redistricting process....General Assembly?

Together, our Student Ambassadors program will be watching. We believe that the fairness that becomes sifted out will reflect the attitudes of our legislative leaders. We believe that the final rhetoric will reflect the foundation of trust we will hold in the future. We believe that the accuracy of the statistics that will determine the voting lines will reflect how much the vote will be willfully suppressed. We believe that the policies that get shaped after this next restricting process will reflect the mindset of our leaders. So we will be watching and our vote will resonate.

I will end where I began. But this time, I will pose these questions. Will the next redistricting process of our federal and state legislative map be an exercise of REAL democracy in action? Will we, as adults, demonstrate to our young people that for once we will set aside the wrangling of politics and we demonstrate that their voices ARE heard? Will we, as adults, ensure that all of our voices are heard?

Our young people in Pennsylvania are looking for a cascade of justice! The time is now to finally make that happen! Thank you for the opportunity to share my voice in this process.